

Anil Gogebakan

Teaching Statement

I believe effective economics teaching should help students develop both a strong understanding of economic concepts and the ability to use those concepts to analyze real-world questions. My approach is to make economic reasoning clear and intuitive while giving students opportunities to apply models and evidence to problems they can recognize outside the classroom. I aim to create an inclusive and supportive learning environment in which students feel comfortable asking questions and developing their own economic intuition. At the same time, I set clear expectations and encourage students to engage critically with economic arguments rather than simply memorize results.

Teaching Experience

I have extensive teaching experience across undergraduate and graduate economics. From 2019 to 2026, I served as a teaching assistant for a broad range of courses at the University of Calgary, including Principles of Microeconomics, Principles of Macroeconomics, Econometrics, Intermediate Microeconomics I and II, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Engineering Economics, Petroleum Economics, Energy Economics and Policy, and Monetary Theory. At the graduate level, I assisted with International Trade, Environmental Economics, and Advanced Macroeconomic Theory II.

This experience has allowed me to work with students at very different stages of their economics education. In introductory courses, I have focused on developing economic intuition and showing how simple models can explain real-world decisions and outcomes. In intermediate and advanced courses, I have placed greater emphasis on analytical reasoning, interpretation of models, and connections between theory and empirical evidence.

In Summer 2023 and Spring 2024, I was the instructor of record for Principles of Microeconomics at the University of Calgary. These courses gave me direct responsibility for course preparation, lectures, assessment, and student engagement. Teaching introductory microeconomics reinforced my belief that clarity is particularly important when students encounter economic models for the first time. I structured lectures around key economic ideas, developed graphical and intuitive explanations before introducing formal analysis, and used applications to show students how the models could be used to understand real economic questions.

Teaching Philosophy and Practice

My teaching begins with the principle that students learn economics most effectively when they understand **why** a model works, rather than simply learning how to solve a particular problem. For instance, in one of my Principles of Microeconomics classes, I noticed that students could correctly solve supply-and-demand problems but struggled when asked to explain what would happen in a slightly different setting. This made me realize that my initial emphasis on working through standard problem types was encouraging students to focus on procedures rather than economic intuition. I began spending more time asking students to predict the direction of an effect before drawing the graph or calculating the equilibrium, and then used the formal model to explain their predictions. I found that this helped students connect the graphical and mathematical analysis to the underlying economic mechanism. I therefore try to move between intuition, formal analysis, and applications.

I also believe students learn by actively applying economic ideas. Depending on the course, I use examples based on current economic events, analytical exercises, discussion questions, and empirical evidence. My research in productivity, international trade, and environmental economics provides opportunities to connect classroom concepts with real-world questions involving trade costs, productivity differences, energy markets, environmental regulation, and pollution.

I aim to design assessments that test economic reasoning rather than memorization. In introductory courses, this means combining conceptual questions with graphical and quantitative problems. In more advanced courses, I would incorporate empirical exercises, interpretation of economic evidence, and research-oriented assignments where appropriate. My experience with softwares like Stata and Python also allows me to incorporate data analysis when it supports the course objectives.

Courses I Can Teach and Develop

My training and teaching experience prepared me to contribute to a broad economics curriculum. I can teach Principles of Microeconomics, Principles of Macroeconomics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Intermediate Macroeconomics, Econometrics, Statistics, International Trade, Environmental Economics, Energy Economics, and Monetary Economics. I can also contribute to courses in Productivity and Growth, Applied Economics and Statistics. At the undergraduate level, I would be particularly comfortable teaching core microeconomics, macroeconomics, and econometrics, as well as field courses in international trade and environmental economics. At the graduate level, I can contribute to international trade and environmental economics and courses involving productivity, applied quantitative methods, or economic policy.

I would also be interested in developing courses that connect my research interests with broader developments in economics. For example, I could develop an advanced course on Trade and the Environment, examining how international trade interacts with climate policy, carbon pricing, environmental standards, and global value chains. Another possible course would focus on Productivity and the Energy Transition, combining theories of productivity and growth with empirical evidence on energy markets, infrastructure, technological change, and environmental policy.

Inclusive and Student-Centered Teaching

I view an inclusive classroom as one in which students with different backgrounds and levels of preparation can participate meaningfully while being held to high academic standards. Students arrive with different levels of familiarity with economics and mathematics, particularly in introductory courses. I therefore explain concepts in multiple ways and provide opportunities for students to identify and address gaps in their understanding.

My goal is for students to leave a course able to approach a new economic problem, identify the relevant mechanisms, evaluate evidence, and construct an evidence-based argument. Going forward, I hope to build on my teaching experience by developing courses that combine strong theoretical foundations with empirical applications and contemporary economic issues. My objective is to give students both the analytical tools of economics and the confidence to use those tools independently.